BUSINESS ANALYSIS REPORT | SOURCE: POWER BI DASHBOARD | DATASET: TheLook eCommerce | 2019 – 2024 DATA

TheLook eCommerce
Business Analysis Report

A structured BA analysis of the Revenue & Sales Performance and Customer Behavior dashboards.

11.14M	94K	63K	18K	27K	28.5%
Total Revenue	Total Orders	TotalCustomers	Total Returns	Total Cancels	Return/Cancel Rate

DASHBOARD PAGE 1: Revenue & Sales Performance — Revenue trends, brand/category profit, cancel vs return split
DASHBOARD PAGE 2: Customer Behavior & Engagement — Demographics, traffic sources, top customers, return rate
REPORT SCOPE: Executive Summary | Key Findings | BA Observations | Gap Analysis | Recommendations
KPIs ANALYSIS BY: Business Analyst | 30 Days of BA Essentials

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

// EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

TheLook eCommerce generated 11.14M in total revenue between 2019 and 2024, serving 63,000 customers across 94,000 orders. Revenue peaked sharply in 2022 at 5.33M before declining 51% in 2023 to 2.61M and a further 41% in 2024 to 1.53M. This trajectory represents the most critical business risk identified in this analysis.

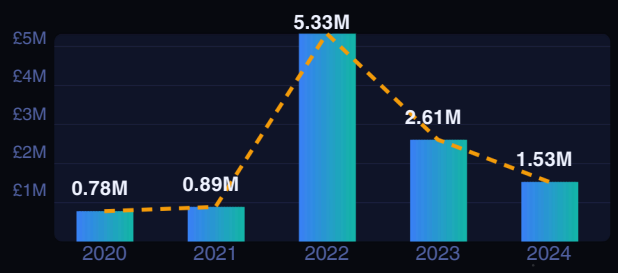
The dashboard reveals strong brand and category concentration in high-value fashion lines, a near-equal gender split in customer base, and a returns/cancellation rate of 28.5% combined (18K returns + 27K cancellations) against 94K total orders. Customer acquisition is heavily search-dependent (70.8% via search), presenting a significant channel diversity risk. Returning customer rates peaked in 2021 and have declined sharply — a leading indicator of customer loyalty erosion that requires immediate intervention.

11.14M	94K	63K	45K
2019-2024 cumulative	Across all years	**TotalCustomers** Uniquebuyers	**Returns+Cancels** 18Kreturns+27Kcancels
5.33M	**–71%**	**28.5%**	**46K**
2022 — highest performance	**Revenue Decline** 2022 → 2024 drop	Returns+cancels / orders	**SearchCustomers** 70.8% of all acquisition

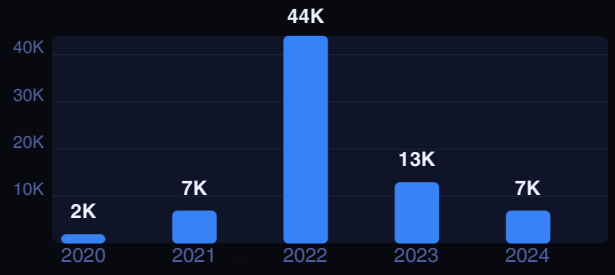
02 DASHBOARD PAGE 1 — REVENUE & SALES PERFORMANCE

Detailed analysis of the Revenue & Sales Performance dashboard — covering total revenue, order volume, brand profit, category profit, and the cancel vs return split.

// TOTAL REVENUE BY YEAR (2020-2024)

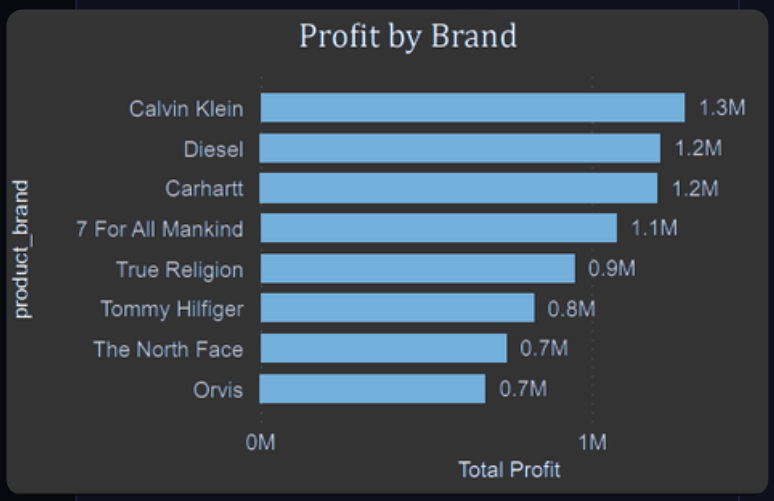


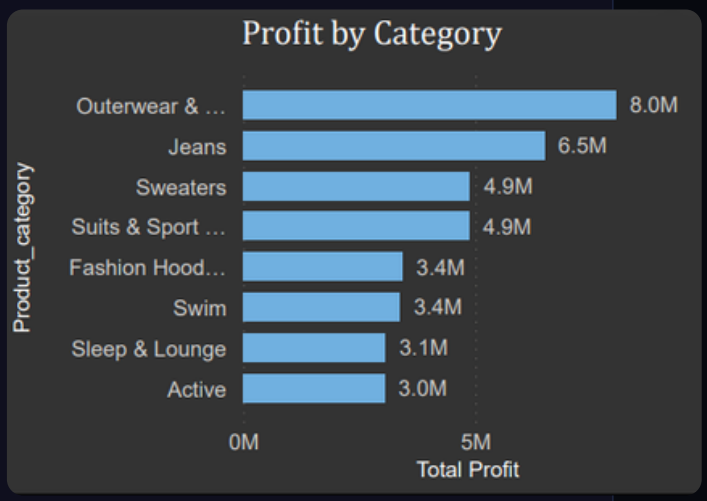
// TOTAL ORDERS BY YEAR (2020-2024)



Revenue Trajectory — A Revenue Story in Three Acts

Act 1 (2019-2021): Slow build phase. Revenue grew from negligible to £0.89M. The business was establishing market presence with limited order volumes (7K orders in 2021). Act 2 (2022): Explosive growth. Revenue surged to 5.33M — a 499% year-on-year increase — driven by 44K orders, suggesting a successful campaign, product launch, or market expansion event. Act 3 (2023-2024): Sharp contraction. Revenue fell to 2.61M in 2023 (-51%) and £1.53M in 2024 (-41%). This is not a normal seasonal decline — it represents a structural revenue problem that requires urgent BA investigation.





// BRAND ANALYSIS

Top brand: Calvin Klein — £1.3M profit
Spread: Top 8 brands within £0.6M of each other
BA Observation: The narrow profit range across brands (£0.7M–£1.3M) suggests no single brand dominance. This is a healthy diversification signal — but also means no brand is generating outsized returns. A strategic brand investment decision is needed: double down on Calvin Klein or accelerate emerging brands?

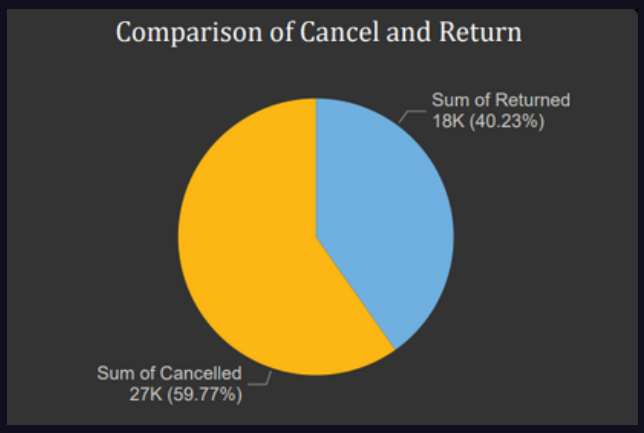
Risk: If any top brand exits the product catalogue, there is no dominant replacement to absorb the revenue gap.

// CATEGORY ANALYSIS

Top category: Outerwear & Coats — £8.0M
Second tier: Jeans — £6.5M
Bottom: Active — £3.0M

BA Observation: Outerwear & Coats is 2.6x more profitable than the bottom category. It also has one of the highest return rates (32.8%) due to sizing issues. A category strategy decision is needed: invest in Outerwear size guidance to reduce returns, or pivot investment to lower-return categories like Active?

The category profit data needs correlation with return rates to calculate true net profit per category.



// CANCEL vs RETURN SPLIT

// CANCEL vs RETURN ANALYSIS

27,000 cancellations (59.77%) outnumber returns by nearly 3:2. This is the more urgent operational issue.

18,000 returns (40.23%) represent product dissatisfaction — driven primarily by size, fit, and description accuracy.

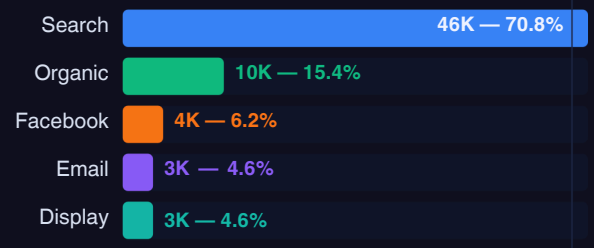
BA Observation — Cancellations:
A 59.77% cancellation share suggests customers are abandoning orders before fulfilment. Root causes: slow delivery promises, payment friction, price shock at checkout, or changed intent post-order. Each root cause requires a different requirement response.

BA Observation — Returns:
Returns are concentrated in Intimates (34.2%), Outerwear (32.8%), and Jeans (31.1%) — all size-sensitive categories. The root cause is clear: inadequate size guidance at point of purchase.

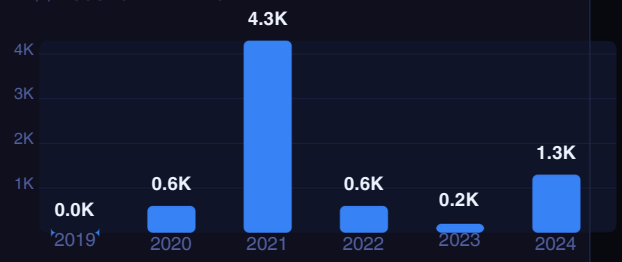
03 DASHBOARD PAGE 2 — CUSTOMER BEHAVIOR & ENGAGEMENT

Detailed analysis of the Customer Behavior & Engagement dashboard — covering demographics, traffic sources, top customers, gender split, and return rates.

// CUSTOMER ACQUISITION BY TRAFFIC SOURCE



// CUSTOMER RETURN RATE BY YEAR



// AGE GROUP ANALYSIS

Peak period: 2022-2023 across all age groups
Dominant segment: Adults (25-54)
Declining segments: All groups falling sharply post-2023

BA Observation: The 2022 customer surge was broad-based — all four age segments (Adult, Kid, Senior, Teenager) peaked simultaneously. This indicates a macro event drove growth (marketing campaign, partnership, or promotion) rather than organic acquisition.

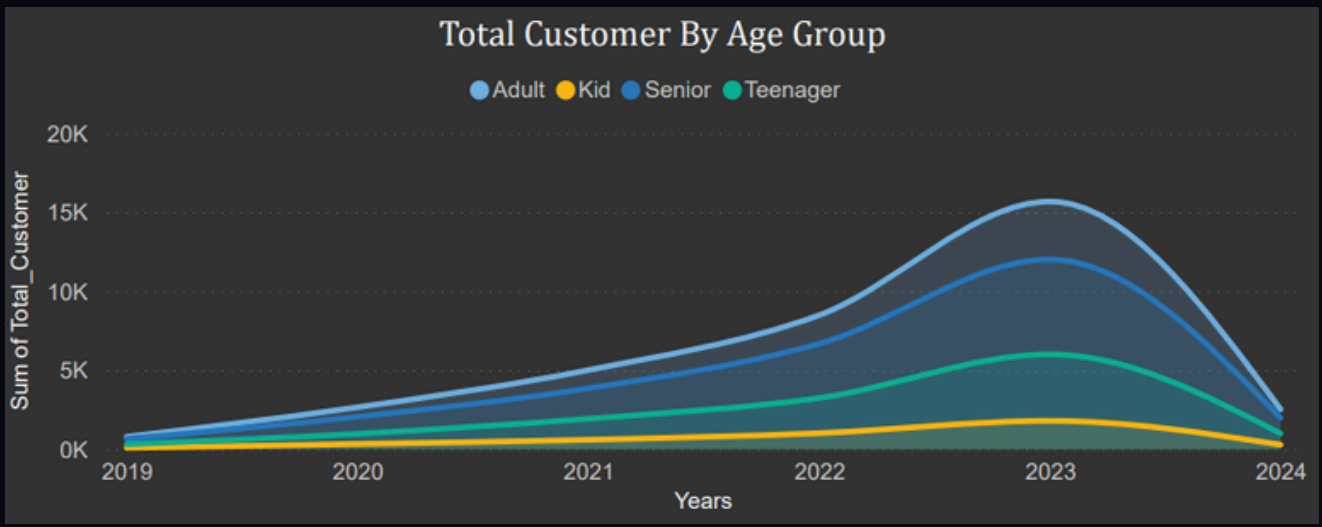
The fastest-declining segment post-2022 appears to be Adults — the highest-value customer group. Retention targeting for Adults must be a strategic priority.

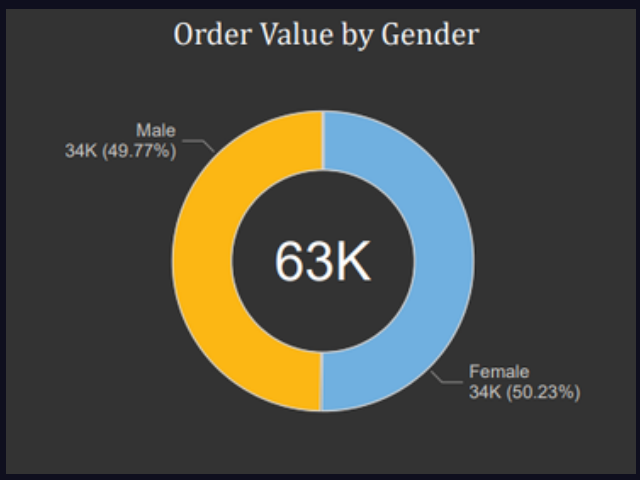
// GENDER SPLIT ANALYSIS

Female: 34K customers — 50.23%
Male: 34K customers — 49.77%
Split: Near-perfect 50/50

BA Observation: The gender split is remarkably balanced at 50/50. For a fashion retailer, this is an unusual distribution — most clothing retailers skew 60-70% female. This suggests either: the product catalogue is genuinely gender-balanced, or the data captures household purchasers rather than end-users.

This data needs to be cross-referenced with product category by gender to validate whether the split is authentic or an artefact of the synthetic dataset.





// GENDER SPLIT

// TRAFFIC SOURCE ANALYSIS

Search: 46K customers (70.8%)

Dominant channel — but this creates existential dependency on search algorithm changes.

Organic: 10K customers (15.4%)

Strong organic presence — indicates good SEO or strong brand word-of-mouth.

Facebook: 4K customers (6.2%)

Paid social dramatically underperforming relative to investment typically required.

Email: 3K (4.6%) | Display: 3K (4.6%)

Email is significantly underutilised for a 63K customer base. A strong CRM programme could convert existing customers to repeat buyers at low cost.

BA Verdict: The channel mix is dangerously concentrated. If search visibility drops by 30%, the business loses ~21,000 customers.

// TOP 10 CUSTOMERS ANALYSIS

RANK	USER ID	EMAIL	TOTAL PURCHASE	BA OBSERVATION
1	21129	ericaconley@example.net	£102.85	Highest value — 14x avg order
2	18126	clintonwalter@example.com	£91.93	2nd highest — loyal repeat buyer
3	88364	stevenbrown@example.com	£41.98	Significant drop-off from top 2
4	91464	lauracooper@example.net	£39.99	Purchase at £39.99 — promo threshold?
5	99661	michaelbrown@example.net	£37.99	Similar value to ranks 4 & 6
6	23930	jackpreston@example.com	£20.99	£17 gap from rank 5 — mid-tier cliff
7	86470	sherribaker@example.net	£20.95	Near-identical to rank 6
8	95744	jenniferlarsen@example.com	£16.00	Low single-purchase value
9	82204	tinaallen@example.org	£9.99	Near-£10 threshold purchase
10	44050	donnabrock@example.org	£7.16	Lowest top-10 — LTV risk

		TOTAL — Top 10 Combined	**£389.83**	Avg £38.98 per customer — low LTV

Top Customer Analysis — The Low Lifetime Value Problem

The combined purchase value of the top 10 customers is only £389.83. The top customer (user 21129) spent £102.85 — which is 14x the average order but represents a remarkably low absolute spend for a 'top customer' in a fashion retailer. This indicates two structural problems: (1) average order values are very low, and (2) repeat purchase rates are minimal. For context, a healthy fashion e-commerce business should have top customers spending £500–£2,000 annually. The current top customer LTV of £102.85 indicates significant customer retention and upsell challenges.

04 BA OBSERVATIONS — DASHBOARD ELEMENT BY ELEMENT

Structured BA observations mapped to each dashboard visual. Each observation identifies the business implication and priority level.

#	DASHBOARD ELEMENT	BA OBSERVATION	BUSINESS IMPLICATION	PRIORITY
01	**Total Revenue (£11.14M)**	Revenue peaked in 2022 at £5.33M then dropped 71% to £1.53M by 2024. The growth curve is V-shaped but not recovering.	Urgent revenue recovery strategy needed. 2024 trajectory suggests structural decline.	**CRITICAL**
02	**Total Orders (94K)**	44K orders in 2022 alone — 47% of all orders in a single year. 2020-2021 and 2023-2024 are significantly lower.	Business depends on one exceptional year. Repeatability not demonstrated.	**HIGH**
03	**Cancel (27K) vs Return (18K)**	Cancellations outnumber returns 1.5:1. Combined 45K vs 94K orders = 47.9% loss rate.	Nearly half of all orders result in no revenue. Root causes unidentified in dashboard.	**CRITICAL**
04	**Profit by Brand — Calvin Klein leads £1.3M**	Top 8 brands are within £0.6M of each other. No dominant brand. No tail brands shown.	No single brand drives outsized profit. Brand investment strategy unclear.	**MEDIUM**
05	**Profit by Category — Outerwear £8.0M**	Outerwear is 2.6x more profitable than Active. But Outerwear also has the highest return rate (32.8%).	Net category profit (after returns) may reorder the ranking significantly.	**HIGH**

06	**Traffic Source — Search 46K (70.8%)**	Single channel dominance. Organic 15.4%, Facebook 6.2%, Email 4.6%.	Algorithm change or ad spend cut would decimate acquisition. Email is critically underutilised for 63K customers.	HIGH
07	**Customer Return Rate — peaked 4.3K in 2021**	Returning customers peaked in 2021 and declined to 1.3K by 2024. A 70% drop in repeat purchase behaviour.	Loyalty and retention programme is either absent or failing. Customer lifetime value is deteriorating.	CRITICAL
08	**Top 10 Customers — Total £389.83**	Combined top 10 customer spend is under £400. Top customer spent £102.85 across all purchases.	Extremely low LTV. Upsell and cross-sell programmes are not working.	HIGH
09	**Age Group Trends — All groups declining post-2023**	Adult segment dominated at peak. All segments declining in 2024.	The 2022 growth was event-driven. Organic growth model not validated.	HIGH
10	**Gender Split — 50/50**	Near-perfect gender parity is unusual for a fashion retailer. May reflect synthetic data or genuine product breadth.	Requires validation against product category by gender for marketing targeting.	MEDIUM

05 GAP ANALYSIS — WHAT THE DASHBOARD DOES NOT TELL US

Every gap identified below represents a missing data dimension, broken business process, or unanswered strategic question — all of which a BA must surface from dashboard analysis.

#	GAP IDENTIFIED	TYPE	ROOT CAUSE / EVIDENCE	PRIORITY
G1	**No return reason data captured at order level**	Data Gap	Dashboard shows VOLUME of returns but not WHY. 32.8% Outerwear return rate cannot be actioned without reason data.	CRITICAL
G2	**No cancellation reason tracking**	Data Gap	27K cancellations (59.77%) have no root cause analysis in the dashboard. Could be pricing, delivery, UX, or change of mind.	CRITICAL
G3	**No net profit by category (returns-adjusted)**	Analysis Gap	Outerwear shows £8M gross profit but has 32.8% return rate. Net category profitability after returns is not calculated.	HIGH
G4	**No customer lifetime value (LTV) metric**	Data Gap	Top customer dashboard shows single-purchase values, not LTV. Returning customer rate declining — LTV trend is invisible.	HIGH

G5	**No channel ROI — revenue per traffic source absent**	Analysis Gap	Traffic source shows customer COUNT but not revenue contribution, ad spend, or cost per acquisition per channel.	HIGH
G6	**Revenue decline 2022→2024 unexplained**	Strategic Gap	A 71% revenue decline over 2 years has no root cause visible in the dashboard. Market conditions, competition, or product issues cannot be distinguished.	CRITICAL
G7	**No cohort analysis — new vs returning revenue split**	Analysis Gap	Returning customer count is shown but their revenue contribution vs new customers is not separated, making retention ROI invisible.	MEDIUM
G8	**No product-level profitability data**	Data Gap	Brand and category profit shown but no SKU-level data. Underperforming products dragging down brand averages are invisible.	MEDIUM

06 STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

8 prioritised recommendations derived from BA analysis of both dashboard pages. Each recommendation is traceable to a specific dashboard finding or gap.

R1 — CRITICAL: Investigate the 2022→ 2024 Revenue Collapse

The 71% revenue decline from £5.33M (2022) to £1.53M (2024) is the most urgent business problem in the entire dataset. A BA-led root cause analysis is required immediately. Hypothesis testing must cover: product catalogue changes, pricing shifts, competitor activity, marketing spend reduction, or fulfilment quality deterioration. Every other recommendation is secondary until this decline is understood and reversed.

R2 — CRITICAL: Build Return and Cancellation Reason Capture

45K orders (47.9%) result in cancellations or returns with zero reason data captured. Implement mandatory reason selection at the point of cancellation and return initiation. This single change will unlock the root cause of the largest operational cost in the business. Categories: size/fit, price, delivery time, product description mismatch, changed mind. Target: 100% reason capture within 30 days of implementation.

R3 — HIGH: Launch a Customer Retention and LTV Programme

Returning customer rate fell from 4.3K (2021) to 1.3K (2024) — a 70% decline. Top customer LTV is £102.85 — critically low for a fashion retailer. Immediate actions: (1) email re-engagement programme for the 63K customer base, (2) loyalty tier structure to incentivise repeat purchase, (3) personalised product recommendations based on previous category purchases. Target: returning customer rate back to 3K+ within 6 months.

R4 — HIGH: Diversify Customer Acquisition Channels

70.8% of customers arriving via search is a single-point-of-failure. A Google algorithm update or increased CPC could reduce acquisition by 50%+ overnight. Required: (1) invest in email programme for the underutilised 63K contact base (currently only 4.6% of acquisition), (2) develop organic social content programme, (3) evaluate Facebook ad strategy — 6.2% share suggests poor ROI vs spend. Target: search dependency reduced from 70.8% to below 50% within 12 months.

R5 — HIGH: Calculate Net Category Profit After Returns

Outerwear shows £8.0M gross profit with a 32.8% return rate. Without return-adjusted profit, the category investment decision is based on incomplete data. Immediate requirement: enrich the Power BI model with return rates per category to calculate and display net margin. This may significantly reorder category investment priorities.

R6 — HIGH: Implement Size Guidance for High-Return Categories

Intimates (34.2%), Outerwear (32.8%), and Jeans (31.1%) account for the highest return rates. All three are size-sensitive categories. Requirement: implement interactive size guides, fit recommendation tools, and size-specific customer reviews for all three categories. Target: reduce return rate by 8-10 percentage points in each category within 6 months.

R7 — MEDIUM: Build a Channel ROI Dashboard

The current dashboard shows customer volume by traffic source but not revenue, ad spend, or cost per acquisition per channel. A marketing efficiency dashboard is needed to show: CAC per channel, revenue per channel, and channel LTV contribution. Without this, marketing budget decisions are based on volume metrics, not profit metrics.

R8 — MEDIUM: Introduce Cohort Analysis for Revenue Attribution

The dashboard cannot distinguish revenue generated by new vs returning customers. Build a cohort model that shows: revenue by customer acquisition year, average orders per cohort, and LTV curve by cohort. This will identify which acquisition years produced the most durable customers and allow marketing to target similar acquisition profiles.

07 KPI REGISTER — 10 METRICS TO TRACK RECOVERY

10 KPIs defined to measure the success of the 8 strategic recommendations. Each has a current baseline from the dashboard, a measurable target, and a defined measurement method.

KPI	TYPE	CURRENT	TARGET	MEASUREMENT
Annual Revenue	Lagging	£1.53M (2024)	**£3.5M by end 2025**	Total revenue — Power BI revenue dashboard, monthly

Cancel + Return Rate	**Lagging**	47.9% combined	**< 25% within 12 months**	Cancels + returns / total orders — order management system
Return Reason Capture Rate	**Quality**	0% (none)	**100% from launch**	Returns with reason selected / total returns — portal log
Repeat Customer Rate	**Leading**	1.3K (2024)	**> 4K by end 2025**	Returning customers / total customers — CRM monthly
Top Customer LTV	**Outcome**	£102.85	**> £500 avg LTV**	Avg annual spend per top-decile customer — CRM report
Email Channel Share	**Leading**	4.6%	**> 20% of acquisition**	Email-attributed customers / total customers — GA4
Search Channel Dependency	**Efficiency**	70.8%	**< 50% within 12 months**	Search customers / total customers — GA4 channel report
Net Category Margin	**Quality**	Not measured	**Tracked for top 4 cats**	Gross profit - returns cost per category — finance + BI
Return Rate (Outerwear)	**Lagging**	32.8%	**< 22% within 6 months**	Returns / orders by category — order management system
Return Rate (Jeans)	**Lagging**	31.1%	**< 20% within 6 months**	Returns / orders by category — order management system

08 HIGH-LEVEL REQUIREMENTS — WHAT NEEDS TO BE BUILT

High-level functional and non-functional requirements derived from the gap analysis and recommendations. These form the starting point for a full requirements register.

- **FR-01 — Return Reason Capture:** The returns portal shall require customers to select a standardised return reason from a predefined list before initiating any return. Reason categories: Wrong size, Not as described, Damaged/defective, Changed mind, Delivery delay, Other (with text field). 100% capture rate required.
- **FR-02 — Cancellation Reason Capture:** The order cancellation flow shall require selection of a standardised cancellation reason before confirming cancellation. Reason categories: Changed mind, Found cheaper, Delivery time, Payment issue, Ordered by mistake, Other.
- **FR-03 — Size Guidance Integration:** Product pages for Intimates, Outerwear, and Jeans categories shall display an interactive size guide with actual measurements and a "find my size" tool based on the customer's saved measurements or inputs.
- **FR-04 — Customer Retention Dashboard:** The CRM shall display a cohort analysis view showing new vs returning customer revenue, LTV curve, and re-engagement campaign performance — updated weekly.
- **FR-05 — Channel ROI Dashboard:** The marketing dashboard shall display cost per acquisition, revenue per channel, and LTV by acquisition source — updated monthly with data from GA4, ad platforms, and order management system.
- **NFR-01 — Return Reason Data Availability:** Return reason data shall be available in the Power BI data model within 24 hours of capture — enabling daily dashboard refresh.

- **NFR-02 — Size Guide Performance:** The size guide tool shall load within 2 seconds for 99% of requests and function without JavaScript-blocking on all supported browsers.
- **NFR-03 — Email Programme Volume:** The CRM email infrastructure shall support a minimum of 63,000 monthly email sends with delivery rate exceeding 98% and unsubscribe processing within 24 hours.

09 CONCLUSION & NEXT STEPS

// CONCLUSION

The TheLook eCommerce dashboard reveals a business at a critical inflection point. The 2022 revenue peak of £5.33M demonstrated the market potential — but the 71% decline to £1.53M in 2024 indicates that potential is not being sustained.

Three structural problems drive this analysis:

1. Data blindness: 47.9% of orders result in a cancel or return with zero reason data captured. The business cannot improve what it cannot measure.

2. Loyalty failure: Returning customers fell 70% from 2021 to 2024. Top customer LTV of £102.85 is commercially unsustainable for a fashion retailer.

3. Channel concentration: 70.8% of acquisition via search with email at 4.6% represents a single-point-of-failure in the growth model.

The path forward is clear: capture the missing data (R2), rebuild customer loyalty (R3), diversify acquisition (R4), and calculate true net margin by category (R5). These four actions — all grounded in the dashboard analysis — represent the minimum viable intervention to reverse the current trajectory.

// RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS — BA ACTIONS

- Conduct stakeholder interviews to investigate the 2022 revenue spike and 2023-2024 decline. Identify which business events, campaigns, or market conditions drove the change.
- Define and document the return reason and cancellation reason taxonomy. Get sign-off from CS, Merchandising, and Finance. Build FR-01 and FR-02 requirements.
- Build the return-adjusted category profit model in Power BI. Cross-reference gross profit by category with return rates to produce net margin view.
- Audit the CRM database for email programme readiness. Identify the percentage of 63K customers with valid email, purchase history, and category preferences for segmentation.
- Design and launch the first cohort retention email campaign targeting the 4.3K customers acquired in 2021 (the highest return rate year). Measure re-engagement against a 15% open rate and 3% conversion target.
- Build the size guide requirements for Intimates, Outerwear, and Jeans. Deliver as a single sprint with QA sign-off against the NFR-02 performance standard. Track return rate change at 60 days post-launch.

The dashboard shows the WHAT.

Business Analysis uncovers the WHY — and defines exactly WHAT TO BUILD to fix it.

Revenue is declining. Cancellations are untracked. Returns have no reason data. Loyalty is collapsing. Channel dependency is dangerous.

Every one of these problems has a requirement. Every requirement has a KPI. Every KPI has a target. That is Business Analysis.

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